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Modern, Czech, Snake, and Blumenfeld Benoni Systems

Use space, restrain Black's breaks, and convert the central wedge into active play

COURSE BOOK

20 focused chapters - model positions - decision rules - retrieval practice

Designed to change what you notice, calculate, remember, and do at the board.

How to Use This Course

ONE CHAPTER, FOUR PASSES

1. Read the position without moving pieces. 2. State your plan and the opponent's counterplay. 3. Study the decision rules. 4. Close the book and reconstruct the position from memory.

RETRIEVAL SCHEDULE

Review the chapter the next day, one week later, and after a game that reaches a similar structure. Retrieval is more valuable than rereading.

BOARD ROUTINE

Opponent's threat - forcing moves - loose pieces - worst piece - central break - best reply - choose and stop.

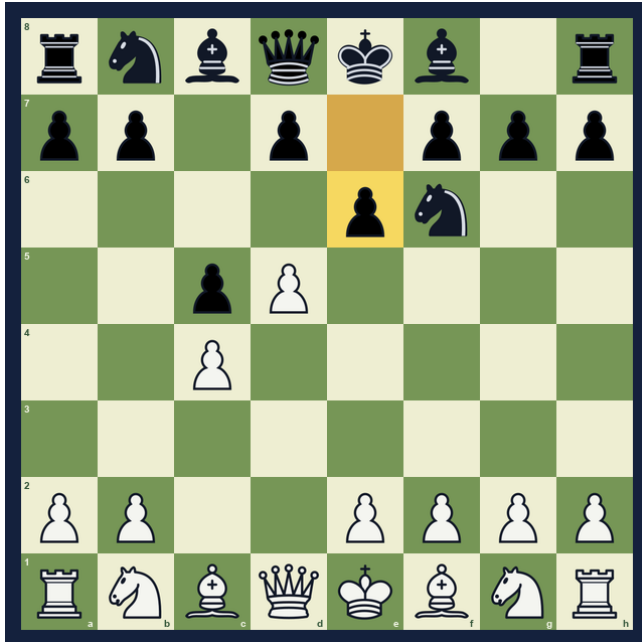
The course book explains each model position. The separate workbook forces recall, prediction, and self-scoring. Use the book first, then attempt the matching workbook page without looking back.

Engine evaluations are intentionally not the lesson. The aim is to store human decision rules that remain useful when the exact move order changes.

Course Map

MODULE	CHAPTERS
BENONI SYSTEMS	20

01. Modern Benoni Core - Move Order



BENONI SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Modern Benoni Core structure while preserving White's central options.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop toward the intended pawn structure, identify Black's freeing move, and avoid spending tempi on a plan the position has not earned.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black attacks the center with ...b5, ...f5, and piece pressure on e4.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to Modern Benoni Core.

01. Decision Framework

Modern Benoni Core - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

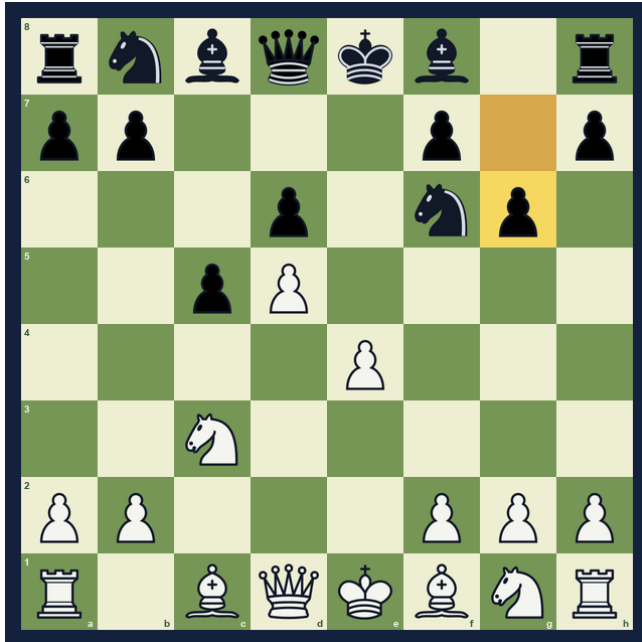
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to Modern Benoni Core.

02. Modern Benoni Core



BENONI SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

White owns central space while Black gains active diagonals and queenside breaks.

PRIMARY PLAN

Support e4, complete development, and use the space before Black achieves ...b5 or ...f5.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black attacks the center with ...b5, ...f5, and piece pressure on e4.

REFERENCE LINE 1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5 5. cxd5 d6 6. e4 g6

MEMORY RULE

In the Benoni, space is an asset only when Black's breaks are restrained.

02. Decision Framework

Modern Benoni Core

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
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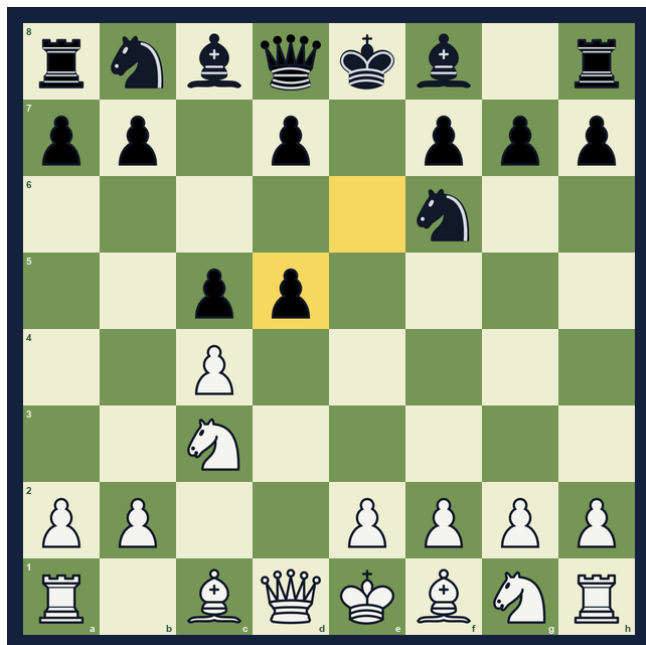
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: In the Benoni, space is an asset only when Black's breaks are restrained.

03. Classical Benoni Development - Move Order



BENONI SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Classical Benoni Development structure while preserving White's central options.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop toward the intended pawn structure, identify Black's freeing move, and avoid spending tempi on a plan the position has not earned.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black seeks ...Re8, ...b5, or ...Na6-c7 before the center becomes restrictive.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to Classical Benoni Development.

03. Decision Framework

Classical Benoni Development - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
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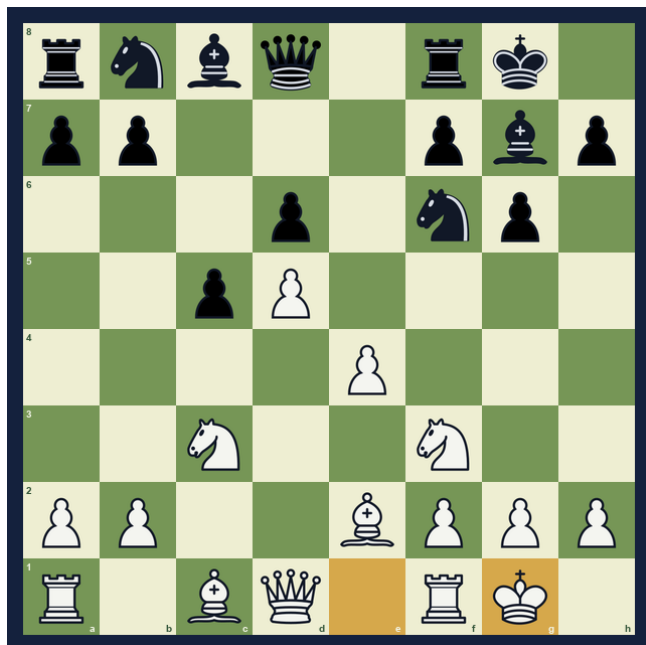
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to Classical Benoni Development.

04. Classical Benoni Development



BENONI SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

White develops safely behind the central wedge and keeps several plans available.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use Nd2-c4, Bf4, or Re1 and prepare the queenside expansion with a4.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black seeks ...Re8, ...b5, or ...Na6-c7 before the center becomes restrictive.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5 5. cxd5 d6 6. e4 g6 7. Nf3 Bg7 8. Be2 O-O 9. O-O

MEMORY RULE

Classical development buys time to choose the correct wing.

04. Decision Framework

Classical Benoni Development

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
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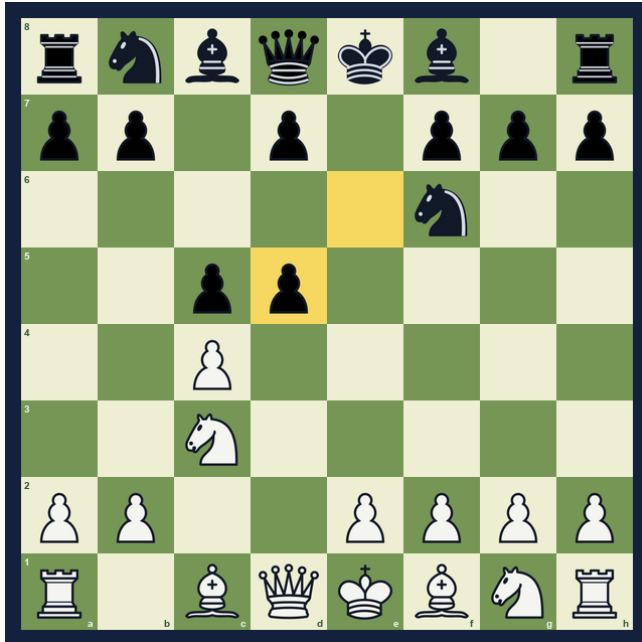
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Classical development buys time to choose the correct wing.

05. Fianchetto Benoni - Move Order



BENONI SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Fianchetto Benoni structure while preserving White's central options.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop toward the intended pawn structure, identify Black's freeing move, and avoid spending tempi on a plan the position has not earned.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses ...a6, ...b5, and pressure on d5.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to Fianchetto Benoni.

05. Decision Framework

Fianchetto Benoni - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to Fianchetto Benoni.

06. Fianchetto Benoni



BENONI SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

White uses the long diagonal to reduce Black's queenside activity.

PRIMARY PLAN

Prepare Nd2-c4, e4, and a4 while keeping the king secure.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses ...a6, ...b5, and pressure on d5.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5 5. cxd5 d6 6. Nf3 g6 7. g3 Bg7 8. Bg2 O-O 9. O-O

MEMORY RULE

The fianchetto restrains queenside play before White expands.

06. Decision Framework

Fianchetto Benoni

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

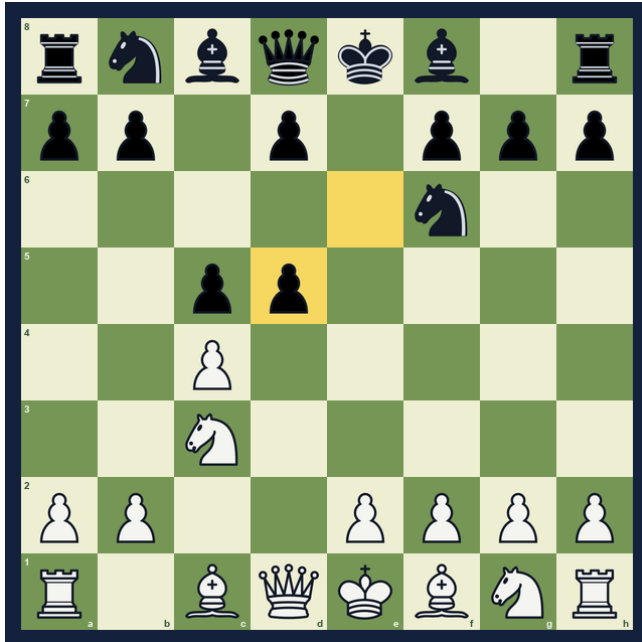
ACTIVE RECALL

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2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The fianchetto restrains queenside play before White expands.

07. Taimanov Benoni Check - Move Order



BENONI SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Taimanov Benoni Check structure while preserving White's central options.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop toward the intended pawn structure, identify Black's freeing move, and avoid spending tempi on a plan the position has not earned.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black attacks c3 and e4 and seeks ...a6 or ...Qh4+ tactics.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to Taimanov Benoni Check.

07. Decision Framework

Taimanov Benoni Check - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
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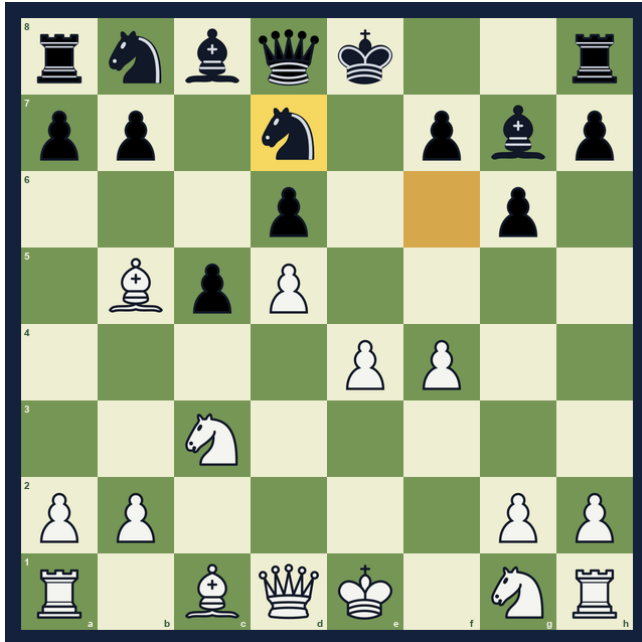
ACTIVE RECALL

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2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to Taimanov Benoni Check.

08. Taimanov Benoni Check



BENONI SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

White uses a check to disrupt Black's normal development and supports an aggressive center.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop quickly, keep e4 secure, and calculate e5 before opening the position.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black attacks c3 and e4 and seeks ...a6 or ...Qh4+ tactics.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5 5. cxd5 d6 6. e4 g6 7. f4 Bg7 8. Bb5+ Nfd7

MEMORY RULE

The check matters because it changes Black's piece placement.

08. Decision Framework

Taimanov Benoni Check

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
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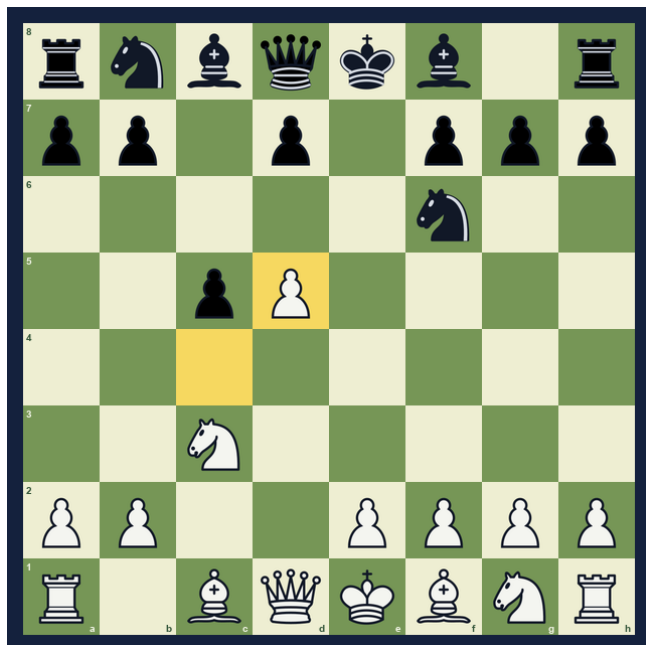
ACTIVE RECALL

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2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The check matters because it changes Black's piece placement.

09. Benoni Knight Route - Move Order



BENONI SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Benoni Knight Route structure while preserving White's central options.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop toward the intended pawn structure, identify Black's freeing move, and avoid spending tempi on a plan the position has not earned.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses ...Na6-c7, ...b5, or ...Nh5 to challenge the setup.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5 5. cxd5

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to Benoni Knight Route.

09. Decision Framework

Benoni Knight Route - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
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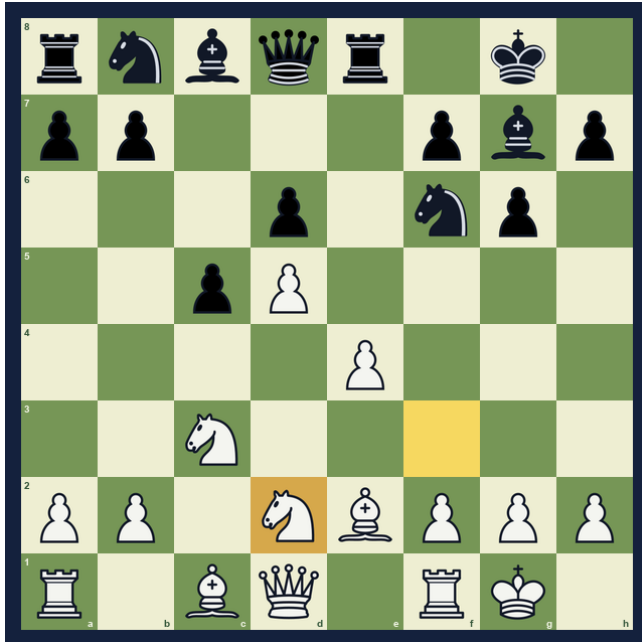
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3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to Benoni Knight Route.

10. Benoni Knight Route



BENONI SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

The d2-knight aims for c4, where it pressures d6 and supports queenside play.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use Nc4 with a4 and Bf4, but verify that Black cannot win e4 by force.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses ...Na6-c7, ...b5, or ...Nh5 to challenge the setup.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5 5. cxd5 d6 6. e4 g6 7. Nf3 Bg7 8. Be2 O-O 9. O-O Re8 10. Nd2

MEMORY RULE

The c4 outpost is useful when e4 remains fully defended.

10. Decision Framework

Benoni Knight Route

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
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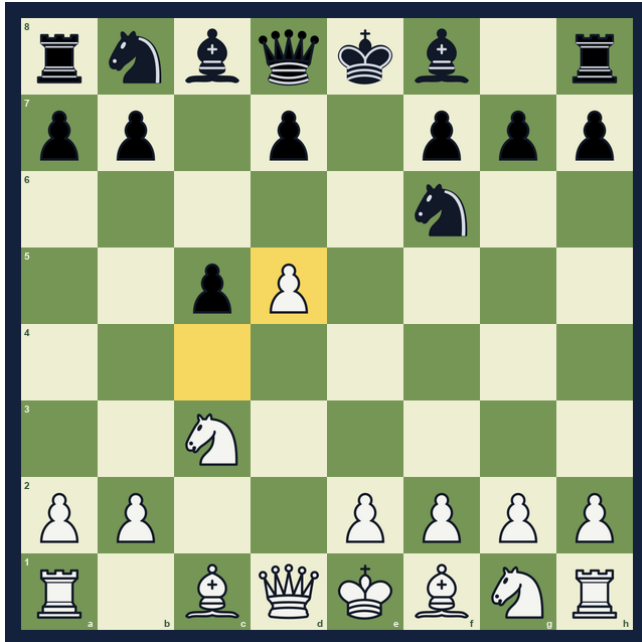
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3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The c4 outpost is useful when e4 remains fully defended.

11. Stop the ...b5 Break - Move Order



BENONI SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Stop the ...b5 Break structure while preserving White's central options.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop toward the intended pawn structure, identify Black's freeing move, and avoid spending tempi on a plan the position has not earned.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black may use ...Re8, ...Nbd7, and ...Ne5 to redirect toward the center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5 5. cxd5

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to Stop the ...b5 Break.

11. Decision Framework

Stop the ...b5 Break - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to Stop the ...b5 Break.

12. Stop the ...b5 Break



BENONI SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

Black announces queenside expansion; White fixes b5 before it gains space.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use a4, Bf4, and Nd2-c4 to restrict Black and increase pressure on d6.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black may use ...Re8, ...Nbd7, and ...Ne5 to redirect toward the center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5 5. cxd5 d6 6. e4 g6 7. Nf3 Bg7 8. Be2 O-O 9. O-O a6 10. a4

MEMORY RULE

Meet ...a6 with a4 when preventing ...b5 supports the rest of the plan.

12. Decision Framework

Stop the ...b5 Break

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
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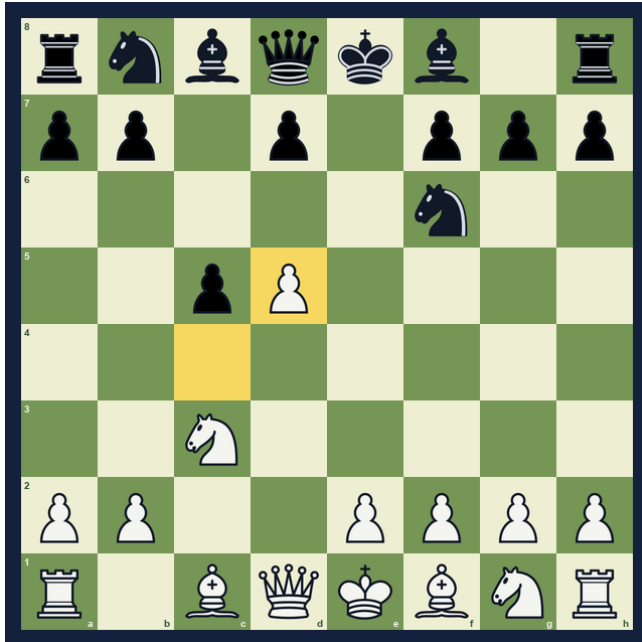
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
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3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Meet ...a6 with a4 when preventing ...b5 supports the rest of the plan.

13. The e5 Space Break - Move Order



BENONI SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

Reach the The e5 Space Break structure while preserving White's central options.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop toward the intended pawn structure, identify Black's freeing move, and avoid spending tempi on a plan the position has not earned.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses ...Nbd7, ...Ne5, and tactical pressure against e4.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5 5. cxd5

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to The e5 Space Break.

13. Decision Framework

The e5 Space Break - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
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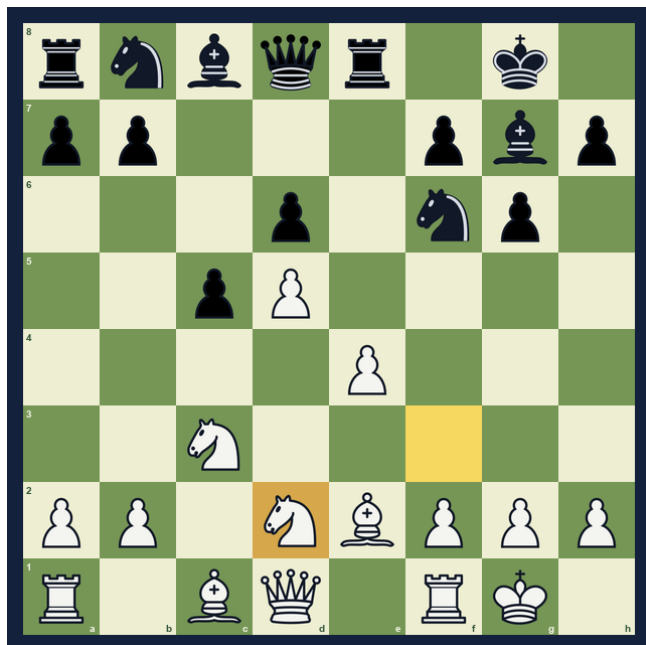
ACTIVE RECALL

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2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to The e5 Space Break.

14. The e5 Space Break



BENONI SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

White may prepare e5 to open lines and dislodge the f6-knight.

PRIMARY PLAN

Play e5 only after checking the exchanges on e5 and the fate of the d5-pawn.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses ...Nbd7, ...Ne5, and tactical pressure against e4.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5 5. cxd5 d6 6. e4 g6 7. Nf3 Bg7 8. Be2 O-O 9. O-O Re8 10. Nd2

MEMORY RULE

A central break is good when the resulting files favor White's developed pieces.

14. Decision Framework

The e5 Space Break

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

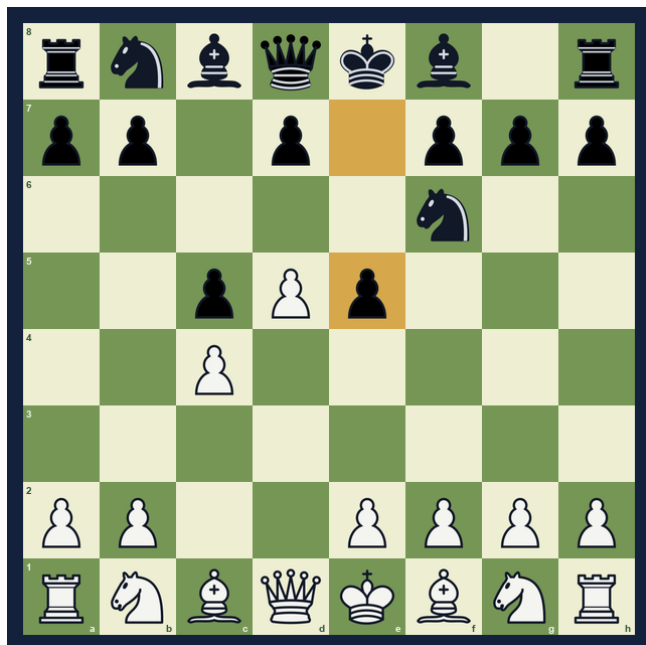
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: A central break is good when the resulting files favor White's developed pieces.

15. Czech Benoni - Move Order



BENONI SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Czech Benoni structure while preserving White's central options.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop toward the intended pawn structure, identify Black's freeing move, and avoid spending tempi on a plan the position has not earned.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black maneuvers with ...Ne8, ...g6, and ...f5.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e5

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to Czech Benoni.

15. Decision Framework

Czech Benoni - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

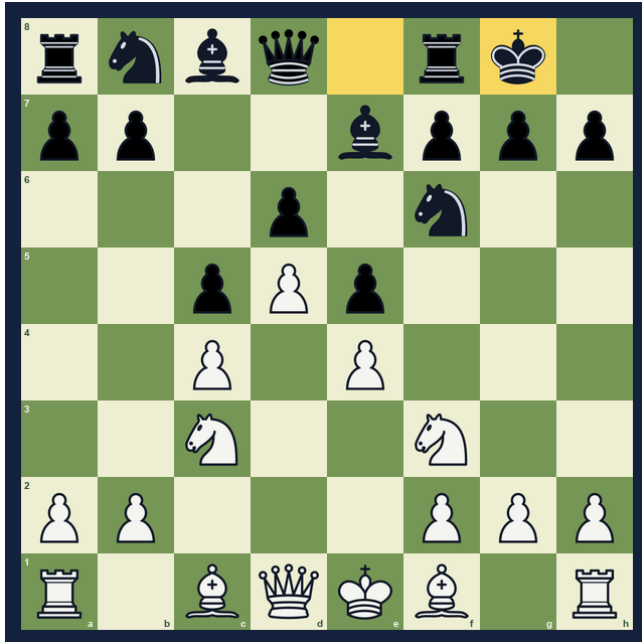
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to Czech Benoni.

16. Czech Benoni



BENONI SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

Black closes the center with ...e5 and concedes space for a compact structure.

PRIMARY PLAN

Improve pieces, prepare f4 or b4, and avoid closing both wings without a breakthrough.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black maneuvers with ...Ne8, ...g6, and ...f5.

REFERENCE LINE 1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e5 4. Nc3 d6 5. e4 Be7 6. Nf3 O-O

MEMORY RULE

In the Czech Benoni, prepare the pawn break before gaining more space.

16. Decision Framework

Czech Benoni

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

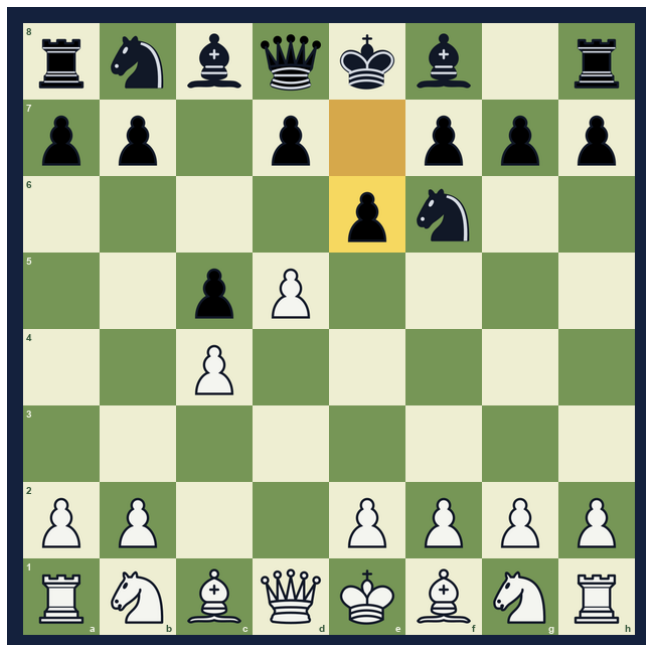
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: In the Czech Benoni, prepare the pawn break before gaining more space.

17. Snake Benoni - Move Order



BENONI SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Snake Benoni structure while preserving White's central options.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop toward the intended pawn structure, identify Black's freeing move, and avoid spending tempi on a plan the position has not earned.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black seeks ...Re8, ...Be5, and pressure on the king.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to Snake Benoni.

17. Decision Framework

Snake Benoni - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

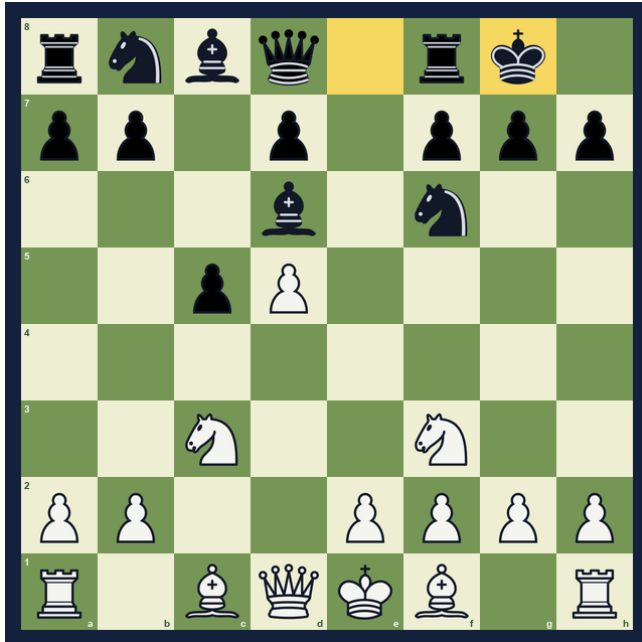
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to Snake Benoni.

18. Snake Benoni



BENONI SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

Black develops the bishop to d6 before ...d6 and aims directly at h2.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use e4, Be2, and O-O while denying a kingside tactic and exploiting Black's unusual bishop placement.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black seeks ...Re8, ...Be5, and pressure on the king.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5 5. cxd5 Bd6 6. Nf3 O-O

MEMORY RULE

Answer the Snake's direct bishop with central development and tactical care.

18. Decision Framework

Snake Benoni

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Answer the Snake's direct bishop with central development and tactical care.

19. Blumenfeld Countergambit - Move Order



BENONI SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Blumenfeld Countergambit structure while preserving White's central options.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop toward the intended pawn structure, identify Black's freeing move, and avoid spending tempi on a plan the position has not earned.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses ...Be7, ...O-O, and central pawns for initiative.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 c5

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to Blumenfeld Countergambit.

19. Decision Framework

Blumenfeld Countergambit - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

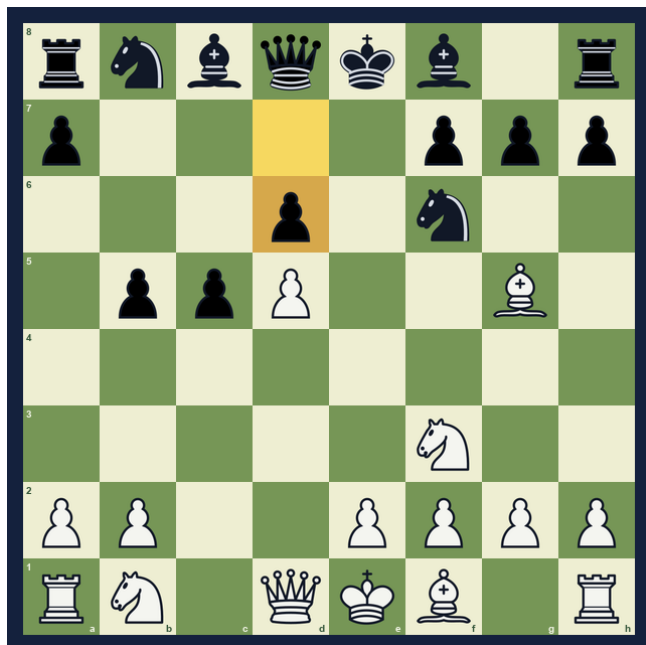
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know which Black reply changes the route to Blumenfeld Countergambit.

20. Blumenfeld Countergambit



BENONI SYSTEMS

READ THE POSITION

Black offers a queenside pawn to build a broad center and open lines.

PRIMARY PLAN

Finish development, challenge the center, and take material only when Black's activity is controlled.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses ...Be7, ...O-O, and central pawns for initiative.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 c5 4. d5 b5 5. Bg5 exd5 6. cxd5 d6

MEMORY RULE

Against a countergambit, neutralize development before proving the extra pawn.

20. Decision Framework

Blumenfeld Countergambit

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, pins, and Black's strongest central reply.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against a countergambit, neutralize development before proving the extra pawn.

Course Completion Test

Choose ten chapters at random. Rebuild each reference position, name both sides' plans, identify the critical break, and state the trade filter without reopening the chapter.

Score one point for the structure, one for your plan, one for counterplay, one for the break, and one for the memory rule. Forty out of fifty means the knowledge is usable; below forty means retrieval practice should continue.

FINAL PRINCIPLE

A course is complete when its ideas appear in your decisions, not when its pages have been read.